

OnePlus Pad 4

A great tablet unless you already own the last one

The moment I started using the OnePlus Pad 4, I immediately felt a certain familiarity. If you haven't guessed it, by familiarity, I am referring to the OnePlus Pad 3. Compared to last year's model, the design feels the same, the display looks similar, and even the overall experience doesn't feel drastically different at first. Yes, on paper, the Pad 4 comes with its fair share of upgrades, but they don't stand out instantly, and at first glance, it all feels predictable. Of course, predictability is not always a bad thing. When a product already works well, the focus shifts from adding new features to refining the overall experience.

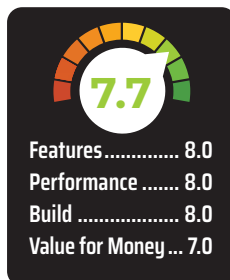
After spending a couple of weeks with the OnePlus Pad 4, one thing is clear: this is more of an evolutionary upgrade rather than a revolutionary one. What I mean to say is that the improvements are there, but they're subtle, and you only start noticing them over time.

DISPLAY AND AUDIO

The display continues to be the centre-piece of the OnePlus Pad 4. It uses the same 13.2-inch LTPS LCD panel with a 3.4K resolution and a super smooth 144Hz refresh rate. Most of the time, it delivers a sharp and fluid experience. The noticeable change is brightness.

OnePlus claims up to 1,000 nits in high brightness mode (HBM), and in our testing at Digit Test Labs, the display easily went past the claims and reached around 1,080 nits. That extra

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difference, especially outdoors or in bright environments, really adds up to the overall experience.

Even indoors, the OnePlus Pad 4 delivers a consistent experience. The display is vibrant, smooth, and sharp. Being an IPS LCD means blacks and the contrast are not as deep as you'd get on an AMOLED screen. Plus, there is a slight colour shift when you look at different angles. But, looking at it head-on, and generally for most use cases, it performs well.

For me, the 7:5 aspect ratio continues to stand out. It feels more practical for reading, browsing, and multitasking compared to traditional widescreen formats. While watching content, there are black bars, but that's acceptable given the overall usability.

I have tested the OnePlus Pad 4's display quality at our Digit Test Labs, and the display recorded an average Delta E of 2.7 in the Calman colour test. In the

Colour gamut test, it got 98.4 %. These are solid numbers but not class-leading.

Audio is where it made a strong impression. The 8-speaker setup delivers high volume, with clear vocals and balanced output. Whether you're streaming or casual listening, the experience is reliable. You also get support for a wide variety of codecs, including LDAC, SBC, AAC, aptX, aptX HD, aptX Adaptive, LDAC and LHDC5.0.

STYLUS AND KEYBOARD

Along with the Pad 4, OnePlus also introduces the Stylus Pro, which is one of the more meaningful upgrades this time. It offers 16,000 levels of pressure sensitivity, making it more suitable for sketching, drawing, and note-taking with better precision and control.

There are gesture controls as well, which add a layer of convenience, and practical features like magnetic attachment and the 'Find My Stylus' function improve usability. They also add an extra tip in the Stylus box, and it noticeably changes the writing and drawing experience depending on how you use the tablet. Whether you prefer a smoother glide or a little friction while writing, having that option is genuinely useful.

Now, OnePlus didn't send over the keyboard. From what I've seen, this time they're going with a floating design, much like Apple's Magic Keyboard. It has a trackpad and 16.05mm keycaps, which are larger than those on some laptops. That should make typing feel more spacious and comfortable, especially if you are someone whose work involves a lot of typing.

The pogo pins have also shifted, and they are on the top left of the tablet now, so the old OnePlus smart keyboard will not work with the Pad 4. That means if you are looking to upgrade may need to buy the new accessory separately.

PERFORMANCE

Performance is where the OnePlus Pad